

Sony Aibo

The Sony Aibo is a robotic toy dog. And it's the first toy dog Sony has made in over a decade. Yes, they actually did have a toy dog 11 years ago. And yes, this one, like the previous toy doggo, is available only in Japan.

The Aibo is made using this era's LTE tech and works with an app. It doesn't do much else except attempt to imitate a real dog. But it does that much better than most other toy dogs in the market. It can walk, shake hands, sit, play with a ball, fake scratch itself and do a lot of other things you would expect a dog to do. It's got a tail which can wag, its ears can move too and it can even give you the puppy dog eyes.

Aibo has a 64-bit quad core CPU in it, with touch sensors on the head, chin and back, so it can detect when you pet it. There's a speaker on it to make doggy sounds and there are four mics on it to pick up voice commands. Aibo is priced at ¥179,000 (₹1,03,000 approx) on Sony's Online store and also has a monthly fee plan for the following three years in order to access its LTE features.



Be toothbrush

Many people swear by electric toothbrushes and a lot of dentists will tell you that they do indeed to an extent give your teeth a better cleaning. However, they need to be charged or they may run out of batteries mid-brushing and you're in a pickle.

The folks behind Be promise have put an end to that problem with their toothbrush, the first of its kind. It is a hybrid toothbrush which can give you the performance of an electric toothbrush, but without the need for electricity or batteries.

The makers say that all you need to do to get an electric-toothbrush level cleaning is simply twist the Be a few times before you use it, like those winding toys we used to play with back in the day, and you're good to go.

The Be is on Kickstarter at the moment and you can check them out there. They plan to start shipping by December next year, but one should be wary of Kickstarter campaigns. Prices on KS start at \$49 (₹3,180), and if it actually does what it claims it does, it could just be a gadget worth grabbing.

RoboBee

The RoboBee isn't exactly a new thing, they've been around for a few years now and have been constantly evolving since they were first unveiled back in 2013.

When they were first revealed, all they could do was take off and fly. Since then, they've evolved to be capable of much more – from sticking to surfaces and even being able to swim underwater.

Their most recent accomplishment is that they're now able to dive in and out of water.

This is actually quite significant for something that small in scale. To give you an idea of what we mean, the RoboBee weighs just 175mg. For something that light to break surface tension is quite the feat. In the words of Harvard Professor Robert Wood, "The force from surface tension feels like an impenetrable wall".

So how did they overcome this problem? With rockets. Tiny rockets.

The RoboBee is outfitted with tiny combustible rockets. When it needs to break the water's surface, gas fills a chamber in the RoboBees interior which is sparked and shoots the bee out of the water.



It still isn't possible to outfit the RoboBee with other sensors since, well, there's no room. But maybe in the near future they'll be able to do stuff actual bees do, like pollinating plants.